Adam M. Morgan

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EDUCATION & TRAINING

Visiting Scholar in Experimental Surgery — 2026 — Present
University of São Paulo, School of Medicine (LIM26) — *São Paulo, Brazil*
- *P.I.s*: Analía Arévalo & Guilherme Lepski

Postdoctoral Fellow in Neurology — 2020 — Present
NYU Grossman School of Medicine — *New York, NY*
- *P.I.*: Adeen Flinker

Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology — 2013 — 2019
UC San Diego — *San Diego, CA*
- *P.I.:* Victor S. Ferreira
- *Dissertation:* The Mental Representation of Syntax: Interfaces with Production, Comprehension, and Learning

M.A. in Linguistics — 2011 — 2013
UC Santa Cruz — *Santa Cruz, CA*
- *P.I.:* Matthew Wagers
- *Thesis:* Bridging the Gap between Acceptability and Production of English Resumptive Pronouns

Lab Manager, Language Sciences Lab — 2010 — 2011
Harvard University — *Cambridge, MA*
- *P.I.:* Maria Polinsky

Research Assistant, Speech and Language Perception Lab — 2009 — 2010
Emory University — *Atlanta, GA*
- *P.I.:* Lynne Nygaard

B.A. in Physics and Music, *Magna Cum Laude* — 2004 — 2008
Middlebury College — *Middlebury, VT*
- *Advisor:* Jeff Dunham
- *Thesis:* Geometric Algebra in Relativistic and Non-Relativistic Physics

AWARDS & HONORS

Gibson/Fedorenko Young Scholar Award — 2026
Awarded for "outstanding scientific work," presented at the 38th Annual Conference of the Society for Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2025). Watch those talks: one on ***language production in the brain*** and one on ***Nungon***.

UC San Diego David Swinney Award — 2013

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FUNDING

NIH R21 (Submission pending council review): *Toward Biomarkers of Syntactic Impairment in Aphasia* — *Submitted June 2026; scored 11th percentile*
Impact score: 24 (11th percentile of reviewed applications); final funding decision expected January 2027.
The NIDCD ECR R21 provides 3 years of transitional funding, intended for early career researchers to obtain preliminary data for a subsequent R01.

FAPESP Visiting Scholar: *Exploring Syntax with Electrocorticography: Experimental Designs to understand Language Processing* — 2026 — 2027
FAPESP Award No. 2025/13382-6
One year of funding to help develop an ECoG program at the University of São Paulo (Brazil) School of Medicine, Hospital das Clínicas

NIH NRSA F32: *Syntactic Control of Lexical Activation during Speech* — 2022 — 2025
NIDCD Award No. F32DC019533
Three years of funding for postdoctoral research at NYU

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (GRFP) — 2012 — 2017
Three years of full funding for graduate studies and research

UC San Diego Collaboratories Fellowship — 2015 — 2016
$30,000 toward a ECoG collaboration across the UCSD Departments of Psychology, Linguistics, and Radiology

Museu Parense Emílio Goeldi - Indigenous Brazilian Languages Grant — 2012
Funding for a summer in the Brazilian Amazon documenting *Tupari*, an indigenous Tupian language spoken by ~300 people in Rondônia

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PUBLICATIONS *(*co-first author)*

Morgan AM, Devinsky O, Doyle W, Dugan P, Friedman D, & Flinker A (*in prep*).
The cortical dynamics of higher-order language: An intracranial comparison of sentence production and comprehension.

Cabanzo-Olarte LC, Camargo P, **Morgan AM**, Arévalo A, Navas CA, Miagawa S (*in prep*).
Electrophysiology and language in anurans (frogs) and humans: A comparative neurobiology.

Improta França A, Soto M, Souza G, Novo Gomes J, Camargo P, Nunes M, **Morgan AM**, Lepski G, Arévalo A (*in prep*).
Introducing a Semantic Odd Word Out task for Brazilian Portuguese.

Morgan AM, Yu J, Ögate L, Dono I, & Sarvasy H (*in prep*).
Advance planning and predictive processing induced by Nungon switch-reference marking: Evidence from eyetracking during production and comprehension.

Morgan AM (*submitted; preprint available upon request*).
To understand higher-order language, look beyond comprehension to production.

Improta França A, Soto M, Souza G, Novo Gomes J, Camargo P, Nunes M, **Morgan AM**, Lepski G, Arévalo A (*submitted*).
Validação de um teste de Odd Word Out sintático-semântico para o Português Brasileiro.

Morgan AM, Dono I, Ögate L, Girip S, & Sarvasy H (under revision for *Cognition*; available on PsyArXiv).
Attraction effects in Nungon reveal independent mechanisms for agreement and switch-reference marking.
Preprint: https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qvybp_v1

Morgan AM, Devinsky O, Doyle W, Dugan P, Friedman D, & Flinker A (*2026*). *Science Advances.*
Hybrid spatial organization and evidence for magnitude-independent coding of linguistic information during sentence production.
https://doi.org/10.1126/sciadv.aec0518

Morgan AM & Flinker A (*2025*). *Proceedings of the 14th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing & Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (IJCNLP-AACL 2025).*
A Scalable Pipeline for Estimating Verb Frame Frequencies Using Large Language Models (LLMs).
https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2025.ijcnlp-long.21

Morgan AM, Devinsky O, Doyle W, Dugan P, Friedman D, & Flinker A (2025). *Comms. Psychology.*
Decoding words during sentence production with ECoG reveals syntactic role encoding and structure-dependent temporal dynamics.
https://doi.org/10.1038/s44271-025-00270-1

Morgan AM & Ferreira VS (2022). *Journal of Memory and Language.*
Still no evidence for audience design in syntax: Resumptive pronouns are not the exception.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2022.104368

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*Kleinman D, **Morgan AM**, Ostrand R, & Wittenberg E (2022). *PLOS One*.
Lasting effects of the COVID-19 pandemic on language processing.
https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0269242

Sarvasy HS, **Morgan AM**, Yu J, Ferreira VS, & Momma S (2022). *Memory & Cognition*.
Cross-clause planning in Nungon (Papua New Guinea): Eye-tracking evidence.
https://doi.org/10.3758/s13421-021-01253-3

Morgan AM (2022). *Glossa Psycholinguistics*.
The That-Trace Effect and Island Boundary-Gap Effect are the same: Null Hypothesis Significance Testing demonstrates equivalence in a psychometric paradigm.
https://doi.org/10.5070/G601140

Morgan AM & Ferreira VS (2021). *Journal of Cognitive Psychology*.
Beyond input: Language learners produce novel relative clause types without exposure.
https://doi.org/10.1080/20445911.2021.1928678

Morgan AM, von der Malsburg T, Ferreira VS, & Wittenberg E (2020). *Cognition*.
Shared syntax between comprehension and production: Multi-paradigm evidence that resumptive pronouns hinder comprehension.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2020.104417

Fadlon J, **Morgan AM**, Meltzer-Asscher A, & Ferreira V (2019). *Journal of Memory and Language*.
It depends: Optionality in the production of filler-gap dependencies.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2019.02.005

Kaestner E, **Morgan AM**, Snider J, Zhan M, Jiang X, Levy R, Ferreira VS, Thesen T, & Halgren E (2018). *Language, Cognition and Neuroscience*.
Toward a database of intracranial electrophysiology during natural language presentation.
https://doi.org/10.1080/23273798.2018.1500262

Morgan AM & Wagers M (2018). *Linguistic Inquiry*.
English resumptive pronouns are more common where gaps are least acceptable.
https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00293

Ferreira VS, **Morgan AM**, & Slevc LR (2018). In Gaskell (Ed.), *Oxford Handbook of Psycholinguistics 2nd Edition*.
Grammatical Encoding.

Clemens LE, Coon J, Mateo Pedro P, **Morgan AM**, Polinsky M, Tandet G, & Wagers M (2014). *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory*.
Ergativity and the complexity of extraction: A view from Mayan.
https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-014-9260-x

Polinsky M, Clemens LE, **Morgan AM**, Xiang M, & Heestand D (2013). In Sprouse (Ed.), *Experimental Syntax and Island Effects*.
Resumption in English.

Polinsky M, Gallo CG, Graff P, Kravtchenko E, **Morgan AM**, & Sturgeon A (2013). In Sprouse (Ed.), *Experimental Syntax and Island Effects*.
Subject islands are different.

DIVERSITY, EQUITY, INCLUSION

Clear Direction Mentoring (CDM) 2022—*present*

Board Member (2025—present)
Senior Advisor (2024—25)
Vice President (2023—24)
Mentor (2022—25)

CDM is a nonprofit that aims to diversify STEMM by addressing leaky pipeline issues. We pair high schoolers from underrepresented backgrounds with mentors who are career scientists. As mentors, we help our fellows apply for college, financial aid, and internships, and support them as they navigate family, financial, institutional, and societal obstacles to a STEMM career. I have mentored two fellows in my time with CDM, both of whom are now the first in their families to attend college and whom I am immensely proud of. I have additionally served in various leadership roles with CDM since 2023.

UC San Diego Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion Advisory Council 2014—2019

Psychology Department Representative

On this subcommittee of the UCSD Graduate Student Association, I organized workshops on diversity and implicit bias, led a diversity flyering campaign, and worked on policy to advocate for undocumented students, student workers, and to address bias, underrepresentation, and inequity on the UCSD campus.

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TEACHING

As Instructor

2018 UCSD PSYC 164: Cognitive Development

As Guest Lecturer

2026 University of São Paulo — Neurosciences Specialization Course
Eletroencefalografia intracraniana (iEEG): Eletrocorticografia (ECoG) e estereo-EEG (sEEG)

As Teaching Assistant

2019 UCSD PSYC 134: Eating Disorders

2018 UCSD PSYC 169: Criminology
UCSD PSYC 153: Psychology of Emotion

2017 UCSD PSYC 4: Behavioral Psychology

2016 UCSD PSYC 134: Eating Disorders

2015 UCSD PSYC 101: Developmental Psychology
UCSD PSYC 105: Cognitive Psychology

2013 UCSD PSYC 103: Mechanisms of Animal Behavior
UCSC LING 101: Syntactic Structures

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TALKS

2026	**São Paulo Excellence Chair (SPEC)**. Syntactic processing: Behavioral measures from Nungon (Papua New Guinea) and Neural measures from English speaking epilepsy patients.	*São Paulo, Brazil*
2026	**Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL)**. Cross-modal decoding of syntactic frames from word comprehension to sentence production.📽️	*Geneva, Switzerland*
2025	**Human Sentence Processing (HSP)**, University of Maryland. From single words to sentence production: Shared cortical representations but distinct temporal dynamics. 📽️	*College Park, MD*
	Human Sentence Processing (HSP), University of Maryland. Processing switch reference marking in Nungon (Papua New Guinea): Comprehension and production measures. 📽️	*College Park, MD*
2024	**Society for Neuroscience (SfN)**, Neural Mechanisms of Language Production and Comprehension (Nanosymposium). Low-activity coding of syntax during language production.	*Chicago, IL*
	Intracranial EEG Seminar Series, NYU School of Medicine. The neural dynamics of sentence production: ECoG reveals sentence-specific networks and temporal patterns.	*New York, NY*
2023	**Society for Neuroscience (SfN),** Neural Circuits and Mechanisms of Language and Cognition (Nanosymposium). The neural dynamics of sentence production – ECoG reveals sentence-specific networks and temporal patterns.	*Washington DC*
2021	**Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL)**. Visualizing lexical activation during speech production.	*Virtual*
2019	**Chang Lab**, Department of Neurosurgery, UC San Francisco. Learning and Representing Syntactic Structure.	*San Francisco, CA*
2018	**California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP)**, UCLA. Subcategorization Preferences of Verbs Reveal Syntactic Processing in Evoked Intracranial Potentials.	*Los Angeles, CA*
	Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), University of Hyderabad, India. This is the Structure that We Wonder Why Anyone Produces it: Resumptive Pronouns in English Hinder Sentence Comprehension.	*Hyderabad, India*
	Pronouns in Competition Workshop, UC Santa Cruz. English resumptive pronouns hinder sentence comprehension.	*Santa Cruz, CA*

	California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), UCLA. This is the Structure that We Wonder Why Anyone Produces it: Resumptive Pronouns in English Hinder Sentence Comprehension.	*Los Angeles, CA*
2017	**CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing**, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). Knowledge of a Syntactic Universal Guides Generalization to New Structures.	*Cambridge, MA*
2016	**Center for Research in Language**, UC San Diego. Resumptive Pronouns: What can we learn from an "ungrammatical" construction about grammar, sentence planning, and language acquisition?	*San Diego, CA*
2012	**David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies**, Harvard University. New approaches to linguistic work in Mesoamerican communities.	*Cambridge, MA*
	Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting. Experimental design for field linguistics.	*Portland, OR*
2011	**Universidad Intercultural de Tabasco, México**. Ergatividad y ambigüedad: procesamiento de cláusulas relativas en chol. (Ergativity and ambiguity: Processing relative clauses in Ch'ol.)	*Tabasco, Mexico*

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POSTERS

2025	**American Speech-Language-Hearing Association.** Examining the effects of Deep Brain Stimulation on phonation and articulation in Parkinson's Disease. (Work with Heather Kabakoff and colleagues.)	*Washington, D.C.*
	Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL). Decoding words during sentence production: ECoG reveals syntactic role encoding and structure-dependent temporal dynamics.	*Washington, D.C.*
	Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL). Isolating Syntax with Frequency-Tagged Verbs: An Intracranial Study.	*Washington, D.C.*
2024	**International Workshop on Language Production (IWoLP)**. Low-activity distributed brain networks encode syntax during sentence production.	*Marseille, France*
2023	**Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS)**. Tracking word planning during sentence production with ECoG.	*San Francisco, CA*
	Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL). The neural dynamics of sentence production: ECoG reveals sentence-specific networks and temporal patterns.	*Marseille, France*
2022	**Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL)**. Tracking lexical access during sentence production.	*Philadelphia, PA*
	Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS). Visualizing lexical activation during speech production.	*San Francisco, CA*
	Human Sentence Processing (HSP). Visualizing lexical retrieval during speech production with ECoG.	*Virtual*
2021	**Society for Neuroscience (SfN)**. Visualizing lexical activation during speech production.	*Chicago, IL*
2020	**Architectures and Mechanisms of Language Processing (AMLaP)**. Non-linguistic context affects processing of ambiguous speech.	*Potsdam, Germany*
	CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Massachusetts, Amherst. Subject gaps are not inherently worse than object gaps in islands: Experimental evidence unifying *that*-trace effects and subject-object gap asymmetries in islands.	*Amherst, MA*
2018	**Architectures and Mechanisms of Language Processing (AMLaP)**. Learners generate unencountered novel structures by drawing on knowledge of a universal.	*Berlin, Germany*
	CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, UC Davis. This is the structure that we wonder why anyone produces it: Resumptive Pronouns in English hinder sentence comprehension.	*Davis, CA*

CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, UC Davis. This is the structure that we wonder why anyone produces it: Resumptive Pronouns in English hinder sentence comprehension. *Davis, CA*

2017 **CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing**, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). This is the structure that we wonder why anyone produces it: Resumptive pronouns in English help production but hinder sentence comprehension. *Cambridge, MA*

CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). English and Hebrew Speakers use Language-Specific Strategies to Produce Communicatively Efficient Relative Clauses. *Cambridge, MA*

2016 **Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)**. Resumptive Pronouns Hinder Sentence Comprehension in English. *Bilbao, Spain*

2015 **Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)**. Acceptability Monitoring's Role in Resumptive Pronoun Production. *Valletta, Malta*

Linguistic Society of America (LSA) Summer Institute, University of Chicago. Individual Differences in the Production and Judgment of Islands and Domain General Cognitive Abilities. *Chicago, IL*

2014 **Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)**. English Resumptive Pronouns are Predicted by Bare-Bones Syntax. *Edinburgh, Scotland*

2013 **Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)**. Gap Acceptability Predicts Resumption Rates in English. *Marseille, France*

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CONFERENCE ORGANIZATION

Co-organizer & Chair

2019 Organized Session at the 2019 Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA). With Savi Namboodiripad and Dave Kush — *New York, NY*

EDITORIAL WORK

Ad Hoc Reviewer

2024 Nature Scientific Reports
Frontiers in Language Sciences

2022 Nature
Glossa Psycholinguistics
Human Sentence Processing (HSP)

2021 PLOS One

2020 Cognition
Journal of Neuroscience

2020 National Science Foundation

2019 Linguistic Inquiry
Frontiers in Psychology
Memory & Cognition

2018 Canadian Journal of Linguistics

LINGUISTIC FIELDWORK

Tupari (Tupi), 2012 — *Rondônia, Brazil*

Preliminary documentation of Tupari in an indigenous reserve. Work with Dr. Denny Moore of Museu Paraense Emílio Goeldi, with grant funding from the Museu Goeldi.

Ch'ol (Mayan), 2011 — *Chiapas, Mexico*

Ran a language processing experiment with speakers of an ergative, VSO language. Work with the Harvard University Polinsky Language Sciences Lab.

Q'anjob'al (Mayan), 2011 — *Santa Eulalia, Guatemala*

Ran a language processing experiment with speakers of an ergative, VOS language. Work with the Harvard University Polinsky Language Sciences Lab.

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OUTREACH & POPULAR MEDIA CONTRIBUTIONS

Wittenberg, E & **Morgan, AM** (2021). The mistakes that we deny that we make them. *Babel: The Language Magazine.* https://babelzine.co.uk/babel-number-36-august-2021/

Morgan, AM (2016). Op-Ed: Open letter to UCSD Faculty, Administrators, Graduate Students, and TAs. *The UCSD Guardian. https://ucsdguardian.org/2016/11/21/op-ed-open-letter-to-ucsd-faculty-administrators-graduate-students-and-tas/*

PRESS

NYU Tandon School of Engineering (2025). *Syntax on the brain: Researchers map how we build sentences, word by word.* https://engineering.nyu.edu/news/syntax-brain-researchers-map-how-we-build-sentences-word-word

Nature Reviews Psychology, by Teresa Schubert (2022). *Extended speech planning in Nungon.* https://doi.org/10.1038/s44159-022-00055-x

Austria Presse Agentur (2022). *Psychologists found traces of the Covid pandemic in language processing (Psychologne fanden Spuren der Covid-Pandemie in Sprachverarbeitung).* https://science.apa.at/power-search/14164150806562577733

Science.ORF.at (2022). *The pandemic is also changing language* (*Pandemie verändert auch die Sprache).* https://science.orf.at/stories/3214252/

HVG (2022). *Even language has been reshaped by the coronavirus epidemic: we understand speech differently (Még a nyelvet is átformálta a koronavírus-járvány, máshogy értjük a beszédet).* https://hvg.hu/tudomany/20220617_emberi_nyelv_valtozasa_kommunikacio_koronavirus_jarvany

OTHER SKILLS

Human languages

Native: English
Fluent: Brazilian Portuguese
Conversational (at one point, anyway): Yiddish, Spanish, Italian

Computer languages

- R
- Matlab
- JavaScript
- PHP/HTML
- Python
- Praat